

Winter Consulting

Capstone Project for Winter Consulting ' 2025

Consulting & Analytics Club, IIT Guwahati

Case 3 – Reducing Missed Appointments in a Telemedicine Platform: Product Decisions

Context

Telemedicine platforms have become an important channel for accessing healthcare, especially for routine consultations and follow-ups. By offering convenience, flexible scheduling, and remote access to doctors, these platforms aim to improve healthcare accessibility while optimizing doctors' time and capacity.

As usage has scaled, operational reliability has become critical to sustaining trust on both sides of the marketplace. One key challenge emerging for the platform is ensuring that scheduled consultations are actually completed as planned, without creating friction for patients or inefficiencies for doctors.

Existing Product

The telemedicine app allows users to:

- Browse and select doctors for online consultations
 - Choose and book available consultation time slots
 - Receive appointment confirmations and reminders
 - Complete the consultation and pay after the session
 - Join scheduled consultations via in-app video calls
 - Access digital prescriptions and consultation summaries after the visit
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The Problem

The platform is experiencing a high incidence of missed appointments, where patients either join consultations late or do not join at all.

This results in:

- Idle and underutilized doctor time
- Reduced confidence among doctors in the reliability of scheduled consultations
- Increased customer support interactions related to rescheduling and complaints

Over time, these effects contribute to:

- Lower doctor retention
- Reduced platform credibility
- Pressure on overall unit economics

Key Constraints

Participants should assume the following constraints:

- Doctors operate on tight and fixed schedules
- A significant share of users are first-time telemedicine users
- Internet connectivity and device reliability may vary

Your Role

You are a Product Manager tasked with reducing missed appointments.

You cannot:

- Redesign the entire product
- Assume new hardware or major infrastructure changes

You can:

- Improve existing features
 - Introduce small, focused product enhancements
 - Modify flows, defaults, or in-app interactions
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Deliverables

Participants are required to submit a maximum 5-slide presentation (excluding title slide and appendix) that addresses the following:

- Problem Identification: A clear articulation of the primary problem driving missed appointments in the current product experience, grounded in realistic user and system behavior rather than surface-level symptoms
- A well-reasoned product recommendation that addresses the identified problem without redesigning the entire app
- A concise explanation of why this approach is preferable to alternative interventions
- Identification of key risks or limitations associated with the proposal, along with mitigation considerations
- Success Metrics: Clearly define how the effectiveness of the proposed solution would be measured, including at least one primary metric and one supporting metric

Submissions should demonstrate clarity of thought, focus on the core problem, and practical product judgment.

Evaluation Criteria

Submissions will be evaluated based on:

- Clarity in identifying the core problem
 - Soundness and practicality of the proposed solution
 - Quality of reasoning and prioritization
 - Awareness of risks and feasibility considerations
 - Appropriateness of defined success metrics
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